This lively aromatic soup can be made in a jiffy, if you use canned coconut milk and have a handy supply of chicken stock. It is filling enough to be a lunch in itself.

prawn, chicken, coconut, and lemongrass soup

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 15 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

3½ cups coconut milk
1¼ cups chicken stock
12oz (350g) chicken, cut into slivers
3 stalks lemongrass, heavily bruised (see p25)
½in (1.5cm) piece galangal or ginger, cut into thin matchsticks
8oz (225g) uncooked prawns, shelled
1 red chile, seeded and diced
5 scallions, sliced
juice of 1–2 limes
3 tbsp coarsely chopped cilantro
3 tbsp Asian fish sauce

1 Put the coconut milk and stock into a pan. Bring to a boil. Add the chicken, lemongrass, and galangal or ginger and lower the heat to a gentle simmer. Cook for 10 minutes, uncovered.

2 Add the prawns and cook for another 2–3 minutes, then add all the remaining ingredients. Remove the lemongrass and discard. Taste and add more lime juice or fish sauce, if needed, then serve.

PEELING AND DEVEINING PRAWNS



Pull off the head, leaving the tail meat intact, then peel off the shell and legs with your fingers.



Make a shallow cut along the back of the prawn, then remove the dark vein with the knife tip.